

Tyler Zenisek

Cloud · Backend · DevOps Engineer

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SUMMARY

Cloud and backend engineer with 2+ years building and running a live AWS platform solo, from Terraform infrastructure to cutting monthly spend by more than half. Previously shipped a contract app later adopted by the U.S. military. Cum laude CS grad seeking a cloud, backend, or DevOps role.

PROJECTS

Balisong Flipping Center: Full-Stack Community Platform · Creator & Sole Developer

Mar 2024 – Present · balisongflippingcenter.com · github.com/BalisongFlippingCenter

- Cut AWS spend 62% (\$105 to \$40 a month) by auditing Cost Explorer data and shutting down unused environments.
- Codified 76 AWS resources in Terraform, so production can be rebuilt from scratch with no hand-configured servers.
- Shipped 41 production deploys in 10 weeks (95% success), each tested and rolled out by GitHub Actions in ~2.5 minutes.
- Designed a Spring Boot API (106 endpoints) and React/TypeScript frontend, backed by 494 automated tests.

Latch: Claude AI Assistant · Creator

Aug 2026 – Present · github.com/BalisongFlippingCenter/BalisongFlippingCenterAIPython

- Wrote a 29-scenario eval suite and used its failures to fix prompts and tool definitions, raising the pass rate from 62% to 92%.
- Cut the wait for a first response from about 8 seconds to 1.2 seconds by streaming from AWS Bedrock through FastAPI.
- Enabled prompt caching so about 4,300 tokens of every model request are served from cache at a tenth of the input price.

QuizMaster (Senior Capstone) · Team Lead

Jan 2024 – May 2024 · quizmaster-c66a2.web.app

- Led a 4-person scrum team that shipped a React/Firebase quiz app on schedule, owning 23+ of its user stories.
- Onboarded about 40 test users who built roughly 20 quizzes, and after a demo the app was used in summer classes.
- Set up CI/CD and fixed 13 database bugs through unit and integration testing.

EXPERIENCE

Contract Lead Android Developer · Galileo Innovations

Chicago, IL · Jan 2020 – Aug 2020

- As primary Android engineer on a 4-person team, built login and real-time graphs of medical data streamed over Bluetooth.
- Fixed Bluetooth and WebSocket sync bugs that had blocked the team for a month, roughly doubling our pace toward delivery.
- Delivered a working prototype in 6 months that ran on 30 devices in alpha testing and was later adopted by the U.S. military.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL

Cloud & DevOps: AWS (EC2, S3, CloudFront, ECR, Route 53, SSM, Bedrock), Terraform, Docker, GitHub Actions, Git, Linux

Frameworks & APIs: Spring Boot, Spring Security, FastAPI, React, Redux, REST APIs, WebSocket/STOMP, JWT/OAuth2

Data: PostgreSQL, Flyway, Redis, MySQL

Testing: JUnit, Mockito, Testcontainers, pytest

AI: Claude on AWS Bedrock, LLM tool calling, prompt caching, LLM evaluation

EDUCATION

B.S. in Computer Science · Lewis University · Romeoville, IL · Graduated 2024

Graduated Cum Laude · GPA: 3.5

A.S. in Software Development · College of DuPage · Glen Ellyn, IL · Graduated 2022